

Cat Litter Box Aversion — Action Checklist

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SPOT MEDICAL EMERGENCIES FIRST

- ☐ **Emergency Male Cat Blockage:** Rush your male cat to emergency vet immediately if you see him straining with little or no urine output since this can be fatal within 24 hours.
- ☐ **Immediate Emergency Signs:** Seek emergency care right away if your cat shows blood in urine or stool, repeated straining with no output, extreme pain, lethargy, or vomiting.
- ☐ **Same-Week Vet Appointment:** Schedule a regular vet appointment this week if your cat shows increased urination frequency, small accidents without obvious distress, or stool changes without blood.
- ☐ **Symptom Journal:** Track accidents for at least 3 days before the vet visit, recording exact time, location, and type of waste along with water intake and behavior changes.

PREPARE FOR A PRODUCTIVE VET VISIT

- ☐ **Fresh Urine Sample:** Collect a urine sample using a non-absorbent litter substrate from your vet or a clean container to help your vet diagnose urinary conditions accurately.
- ☐ **Phone Consultation:** Call your vet for a phone triage if you're unsure whether symptoms warrant emergency care since a brief call is far less costly than an emergency visit.
- ☐ **Specific Symptom Description:** Use your written journal to give the vet exact details about the problem rather than general descriptions so they can diagnose and treat more effectively.
- ☐ **Enzymatic Cleaner:** Clean all accident spots with an enzymatic cleaner designed for cat urine since regular household cleaners may leave odor traces that attract repeat accidents.

AUDIT YOUR LITTER BOX SETUP

- ☐ **Box Quantity:** Provide one litter box per cat plus one extra to prevent territorial disputes that can cause cats to avoid boxes and eliminate elsewhere.
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- ☐ **Stress Triggers:** Reduce environmental stressors like loud noises, household changes, new pets, or disrupted routines that may be causing your cat to eliminate outside the box.

 - ☐ **Box Accessibility:** Check whether arthritic or older cats can easily enter the litter box and lower the sides or switch to a shallow entry box if jumping appears difficult.

 - ☐ **Strategic Box Placement:** Ensure litter boxes are in quiet accessible areas away from food and loud household traffic to make them appealing alternatives to carpet or furniture.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.